Craftit AI — Synthetic User Research

> ⚠️ **SYNTHETIC RESEARCH** — All personas, quotes, and findings are simulated. Not real user data. Generated 2026-02-24.

Table of Contents

1. Personas
2. Cross-Segment Synthesis

Personas

SEGMENT 1: Complete Beginners (3)

Persona 1: Linda Chen, 42 — "Birthday Party Mom"

Bio: Stay-at-home mom, two kids (ages 6 and 9). Uses phone for WhatsApp, Facebook, photos. Never used a design tool. Wants to make birthday invitations for her daughter's party.

1. First Encounter Discovers Craftit via a Facebook mom-group post: "I made these invitations in 2 minutes with AI!" Clicks link. First impression: *"Is this like Photoshop? I can't do Photoshop."* Reassured if landing page shows simple before/after examples with "no skills needed" messaging.

2. Onboarding Expects: sign up → tell it what she wants → get result. Confused by: any terminology like "prompt," "model," "resolution," "aspect ratio." Wants a "What do you want to make?" question, not a blank canvas. Would thrive with templates: "Birthday Invitation," "Thank You Card."

3. First Creation Tries: "Pink princess birthday invitation for my daughter Emma, she's turning 7." Easy: typing what she wants and getting an image. Hard: if she needs to figure out aspect ratio, or if results don't include text/her daughter's name correctly (AI text generation is notoriously bad). Frustrated if she can't add/edit text on the image.

4. Repeat Usage Comes back for: holiday cards, school event flyers, family photo collages. Leaves if: every creation requires starting from scratch, no way to save/reuse styles, or results feel "too AI-looking."

5. Pain Points

- Text on images (names, dates) not rendering correctly
- No obvious "edit this part" — wants to tweak, not regenerate entirely
- Overwhelmed by options she doesn't understand
- Worried about cost before she even starts

6. Delight Moments

- First image that looks "professional" — *"I made THIS?!"*
- Being able to share directly to WhatsApp
- Canvas feature letting her add real text overlays to AI images

7. Willingness to Pay Would pay $3-5/month if she uses it regularly. Wants a free tier to try first. Would pay one-time for a "party pack" of 10 designs. Price sensitivity: high.

Persona 2: Rajesh Patel, 55 — "Local Shop Owner"

Bio: Runs a small electronics repair shop. Has a basic smartphone. Posts occasionally on Facebook/Instagram but uses stock photos or phone camera shots. Needs better social media presence but has zero design skills.

1. First Encounter Hears about it from his nephew: "Uncle, try this app, it makes ads for you." Downloads it skeptically. First impression: *"Will this actually understand what my shop looks like?"*

2. Onboarding Expects to describe his shop and get ready-to-post content. Confused by: anything beyond basic text input. Needs language support (may prefer Hindi). Would love a "Social Media Post" template category.

3. First Creation Tries: "Professional-looking ad for mobile phone repair shop, fast service, good prices." Easy: getting a generic but decent-looking image. Hard: making it look like HIS shop, adding his phone number/address, getting the right vibe (trustworthy, not flashy).

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: weekly social posts, festival/sale announcements, WhatsApp status updates. Leaves if: can't easily customize with his branding, or if it takes too long per post.

5. Pain Points

- Can't upload his shop logo and have it incorporated
- Text in local language renders poorly
- Results feel generic — doesn't represent his actual business
- No batch creation for a week's worth of posts

6. Delight Moments

- First post that gets more likes/comments than usual
- Video ad for his shop that looks "like a real commercial"
- Festival greeting with his shop branding auto-applied

7. Willingness to Pay Would pay $2-4/month. Very price-sensitive. Needs to see direct business value (more customers) to justify any spend. Free tier essential for acquisition.

Persona 3: Aisha, 16 — "Fun Content Teen"

Bio: High schooler. Lives on TikTok and Instagram. Loves memes, aesthetic edits, fan art. Uses phone for everything. Has tried free photo editors but finds them limiting.

1. First Encounter Sees a viral TikTok of someone creating wild AI art with Craftit. *"Omg I need this."* Downloads immediately. First impression: wants it to be fast, fun, and shareable.

2. Onboarding Expects: open app → type something funny → get cool image → share. Zero patience for tutorials or sign-up flows. Would skip any onboarding longer than 2 taps. Wants to see a creation within 30 seconds.

3. First Creation Tries: something absurd/funny — "my cat as a samurai in space." Easy: the core generation loop. Hard: if generation takes more than 15-20 seconds she loses interest. Wants instant gratification.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: memes, fan edits, aesthetic profile pictures, TikTok content ideas. Leaves if: friends move to a newer/cooler app, free tier is too limited, or watermarks are embarrassing.

5. Pain Points

- Watermarks on free tier (social stigma)
- Generation queue/wait times
- Can't easily make video memes
- Content moderation blocking creative (but harmless) prompts

6. Delight Moments

- Making something so cool friends ask "HOW did you make that?"
- Video generation from her own photos (reference image feature)
- Community feed where she can get likes/follows

7. Willingness to Pay Unlikely to pay herself (no income). Might convince parents for $5/month if she's hooked. Would watch ads to get free credits. In-app currency/gamification could work.

SEGMENT 2: Casual Creators (3)

Persona 4: Sophie Müller, 29 — "Canva Regular"

Bio: Marketing coordinator at a mid-size company. Uses Canva daily for social posts, presentations, basic videos. Comfortable with templates but not a designer. Curious about AI tools.

1. First Encounter Reads a "Best AI Design Tools 2026" blog post. Visits Craftit website. First impression: *"Can this replace some of my Canva workflow, or is it just another AI image toy?"*

2. Onboarding Expects: professional onboarding, workspace concept, brand kit upload. Confused if: there's no folder/project organization, no way to set brand colors/fonts. Compares everything to Canva's UX.

3. First Creation Tries: social media post for her company's Instagram — product announcement. Easy: generating a visually striking hero image. Hard: making it match brand guidelines, adding text overlays with specific fonts, outputting in exact social media dimensions.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: unique hero images, campaign visuals that would take hours in Canva. Leaves if: can't integrate into her workflow (no export options, no brand consistency tools).

5. Pain Points

- No brand kit / style consistency features
- Can't output in specific social media sizes easily
- No text editing layer on top of AI images
- Inconsistent style across multiple generations

6. Delight Moments

- Generating 10 campaign visual variations in 5 minutes (vs. hours in Canva)
- Canvas feature that bridges AI generation → finished design
- "Style lock" that keeps all visuals on-brand

7. Willingness to Pay Would pay $10-15/month for a tool that genuinely saves her time. Needs it to integrate with (not replace) her existing workflow. Would pitch to her manager for team plan at $20-30/month.

Persona 5: Marcus Johnson, 34 — "CapCut Hobbyist"

Bio: Hobbyist videographer. Makes travel vlogs and family videos. Uses CapCut and sometimes Premiere Rush. Interested in AI for B-roll and transitions.

1. First Encounter YouTube video: "I used AI to generate B-roll for my travel vlog." Intrigued. Visits Craftit. First impression: *"The video quality needs to be good enough to cut into real footage."*

2. Onboarding Expects: video-first experience. Confused if: the app feels image-centric and video is buried. Wants to immediately see video generation capabilities and quality samples.

3. First Creation Tries: 8-second aerial shot of a tropical beach to use as B-roll. Easy: the concept of describing a scene and getting video. Hard: matching the look/feel of his existing footage, controlling camera movement, getting 4K quality.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: B-roll gaps in edits, establishing shots, creative transitions. Leaves if: video quality is noticeably "AI-looking," can't control camera movement, or can't export in formats compatible with his editor.

5. Pain Points

- Video quality/resolution limitations
- No camera movement control (pan, zoom, dolly)
- Can't match color grade of existing footage
- 4-12 second limit feels restrictive for some B-roll needs

6. Delight Moments

- AI-generated B-roll that seamlessly cuts into real footage
- First/last frame feature for perfect transitions
- Being able to extend a clip by generating what comes "next"

7. Willingness to Pay Would pay $15-20/month for high-quality video generation. Values quality over quantity. Would pay more for 4K, longer clips, and camera control.

Persona 6: Priya Sharma, 26 — "Instagram Aesthetic Curator"

Bio: Works in HR by day. Runs a curated Instagram aesthetic/mood board account with 12K followers. Uses VSCO, Lightroom Mobile, and Canva. Always looking for unique visuals.

1. First Encounter Discovers through Instagram — someone tags #CraftitAI on a stunning surreal landscape. DMs them: "What app is this?" First impression: *"If I can make unique content no one else has, this is gold."*

2. Onboarding Expects: style-focused experience. Wants to define an aesthetic and have the tool maintain it. Confused if: there's no style/preset system, or results feel random.

3. First Creation Tries: dreamy pastel surreal landscape in her signature aesthetic. Easy: getting beautiful images. Hard: making them match her very specific Instagram aesthetic consistently.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: daily posts, story content, unique visuals that differentiate her from other accounts. Leaves if: other creators start using the same styles making her content look generic.

5. Pain Points

- Style consistency across sessions (her aesthetic must be exact)
- Other users generating identical-looking content
- No way to fine-tune/save a "style recipe"
- Community feed might expose her "source" to followers

6. Delight Moments

- Saving a custom style and getting pixel-perfect consistency
- Generating a full week of cohesive grid content in one session
- Video versions of her aesthetic for Reels

7. Willingness to Pay Would pay $8-12/month. Would pay premium for exclusive styles or early access to new models. Values uniqueness — would pay for features that make her content distinct.

SEGMENT 3: Content Creators / Influencers (3)

Persona 7: Jake Torres, 27 — "YouTube Thumbnail Machine"

Bio: YouTube creator, 180K subscribers, posts 3x/week. Spends too much time on thumbnails. Currently uses Photoshop + stock images. Wants faster thumbnail workflow.

1. First Encounter Hears about it on a creator podcast. First impression: *"If this can cut my thumbnail time from 30 min to 5 min, I'm in."*

2. Onboarding Expects: power-user features upfront. Wants batch creation, templates, and instant export. Impatient with basic tutorials. Needs to see ROI in first session.

3. First Creation Tries: dramatic thumbnail — "shocked face man looking at giant explosion, YouTube thumbnail style, bold colors." Easy: getting attention-grabbing images. Hard: incorporating his actual face/photo, consistent character across thumbnails, text integration.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: every video's thumbnail, A/B testing variations. Leaves if: can't use his own face consistently, or quality doesn't match top YouTube thumbnails.

5. Pain Points

- Can't use his own likeness reliably (face consistency)
- No text overlay tools for click-worthy headlines
- Can't A/B test thumbnail variations quickly
- Style drift between thumbnails hurts channel brand

6. Delight Moments

- Generating 5 thumbnail variations in 2 minutes
- Canvas feature for adding text overlays
- Higher CTR on AI-generated thumbnails vs. manual ones

7. Willingness to Pay Would pay $20-30/month without hesitation if it delivers. This is a business expense. Would pay more for face consistency and batch features.

Persona 8: Mia Zhang, 24 — "TikTok Content Factory"

Bio: Full-time TikTok creator, 500K followers. Posts 2-3 times daily across TikTok, Reels, Shorts. Needs constant fresh visual content. Has a small team (1 editor).

1. First Encounter Another creator DMs her the tool. First impression: *"Can this keep up with my volume? I need FAST."*

2. Onboarding Expects: speed above all. Bulk generation, API access maybe, preset styles she can reuse. Confused if: the tool is designed for one-at-a-time creation.

3. First Creation Tries: series of 6-second video clips for a trending audio — different aesthetic backgrounds. Easy: single generation. Hard: batch creation, maintaining style across a series, matching trending formats quickly.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: daily content production, trend-reactive visual content. Leaves if: too slow for her pace, competitors offer API/bulk access, or quality plateaus.

5. Pain Points

- No batch/bulk generation
- Can't save and reuse prompt templates
- Generation speed not fast enough for trend cycles
- No direct posting/scheduling integration

6. Delight Moments

- Auto-mode: idea → finished video in one flow
- Generating a full day's content in 20 minutes
- Reference image feature for maintaining series consistency

7. Willingness to Pay Would pay $30-50/month for unlimited/high-volume access. Would pay for API access. Cost is justified if it replaces even part of her editor's time.

Persona 9: David Okafor, 31 — "Multi-Platform Brand Builder"

Bio: Personal brand creator — LinkedIn thought leadership, Instagram motivation, YouTube long-form. Creates content about entrepreneurship. Needs consistent visual branding across platforms.

1. First Encounter LinkedIn post from another creator about "AI-powered content creation." Checks it out. First impression: *"Can it handle my brand across all platforms?"*

2. Onboarding Expects: brand kit upload, multi-format export (LinkedIn banner, IG square, YouTube thumbnail from same design). Confused if: there's no concept of "brand" or "project."

3. First Creation Tries: motivational quote image in his brand style for LinkedIn + Instagram simultaneously. Easy: generating a beautiful image. Hard: applying his specific brand colors/fonts, resizing for different platforms.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: daily content across platforms. Leaves if: inconsistent branding, no multi-format export, or competitors offer better brand management.

5. Pain Points

- No multi-format export from single design
- Brand consistency requires re-prompting every time
- Can't build a visual content library/asset system
- No scheduling or publishing integration

6. Delight Moments

- One prompt → content for 3 platforms in correct formats
- Brand style that stays locked across months of content
- Auto-mode video turning his blog post into a video summary

7. Willingness to Pay $25-40/month. Brand consistency features are the key value driver. Would pay for team collaboration features.

SEGMENT 4: Small Business Owners (2)

Persona 10: Emma Larsson, 38 — "E-commerce Product Seller"

Bio: Runs a small handmade jewelry business on Etsy and Instagram. Does her own photography (mediocre quality). Needs better product visuals and video ads for Instagram/Facebook.

1. First Encounter Etsy seller forum: "This AI tool made my product photos look amazing." First impression: *"Can it actually work with MY products, or just generic stuff?"*

2. Onboarding Expects: upload product photo → get professional-looking variations. Confused if: there's no clear "product photography" workflow.

3. First Creation Tries: uploads a photo of her necklace, wants it on a model in a luxury setting. Easy: generating beautiful scenes. Hard: keeping her actual product accurate (AI might alter the jewelry design). This is critical — product must look exactly right.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: seasonal campaign photos, product launch visuals, video ads. Leaves if: product accuracy is unreliable, or she can't trust the output to represent her real products.

5. Pain Points

- Product accuracy — AI changes details of her actual products
- Can't generate "model wearing product" reliably
- No e-commerce specific templates (product cards, sale banners)
- Needs lifestyle context but with her real products

6. Delight Moments

- Reference image feature preserving her product while changing the scene
- Video ad of her jewelry that looks like a professional commercial
- Canvas feature for creating sale/promo graphics with her product images

7. Willingness to Pay $10-20/month. Direct ROI: better photos → more sales. Would pay premium for product-accurate generation.

Persona 11: Carlos Mendez, 45 — "Restaurant Owner"

Bio: Owns a family Mexican restaurant. Manages his own social media. Takes food photos on his phone. Needs eye-catching content but has no time and no design skills.

1. First Encounter Google search: "easy way to make restaurant social media posts." Finds Craftit. First impression: *"I don't have time to learn another app."*

2. Onboarding Expects: tell the app what his business is, get content. Ideally: "I'm a restaurant" → here are templates and workflows for restaurants. Confused by: any creative decision-making he has to do.

3. First Creation Tries: "Taco Tuesday special, $5 tacos, looks delicious and fun." Easy: getting a food image. Hard: it won't look like HIS tacos. Needs to use his actual food photos as reference.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: weekly specials, event promotions, seasonal menus, Google Business Profile updates. Leaves if: takes more than 5 minutes per post, or results look obviously AI-generated.

5. Pain Points

- AI-generated food doesn't match his real dishes
- No calendar/planning view for weekly content
- Results sometimes look unappetizing (AI food can be uncanny)
- Needs Spanish language support

6. Delight Moments

- Reference image: his actual taco photo → professional food photography setting
- 12-second video ad for Instagram that looks broadcast-quality
- One-tap "post to Instagram"

7. Willingness to Pay $5-10/month. Must be dead simple. Would pay more for a "restaurant marketing" package with templates and scheduling.

SEGMENT 5: Professional Creators (2)

Persona 12: Alex Kim, 30 — "Freelance Graphic Designer"

Bio: Freelance designer, 6 years experience. Uses Figma, Illustrator, Photoshop daily. Evaluating AI tools to speed up ideation and concept work. Skeptical but curious.

1. First Encounter Design Twitter/X thread comparing AI tools. Tries Craftit. First impression: *"Let's see if this is actually useful or just a toy."*

2. Onboarding Expects: professional-grade controls. Wants to understand the model, adjust parameters, control composition. Frustrated by oversimplified UIs that hide controls.

3. First Creation Tries: concept art for a client project — specific composition, color palette, mood. Easy: generating inspiration/mood boards quickly. Hard: precise compositional control, specific color palettes, output resolution for print.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: rapid ideation, concept variations, generating assets to refine in Figma/Photoshop. Leaves if: no export in useful formats (PSD, SVG, high-res PNG), feels like a consumer toy.

5. Pain Points

- Insufficient control over composition and layout
- No layer separation or editable output
- Resolution too low for professional/print use
- No API for integration into design pipeline
- Feels "dumbed down" — wants advanced mode

6. Delight Moments

- Generating 20 concept directions in 10 minutes for client review
- Canvas feature as a bridge between AI generation and design refinement
- Image-to-video for quick motion concepts to pitch to clients

7. Willingness to Pay $20-30/month for a professional tier. Would pay for: high-res output, advanced controls, API access, commercial licensing clarity.

Persona 13: Nina Volkov, 35 — "Video Production Lead"

Bio: Leads a small video production company (5 people). Makes commercials, corporate videos, social content for clients. Exploring AI for pre-visualization, storyboarding, and supplementary footage.

1. First Encounter Industry conference demo. First impression: *"The quality isn't broadcast-ready yet, but storyboarding and pre-vis could be valuable NOW."*

2. Onboarding Expects: project-based workflow, team collaboration, high output quality. Confused if: no project/folder structure, no team features.

3. First Creation Tries: storyboard for a client commercial — 8 scenes, specific camera angles, consistent characters. Easy: individual scene generation. Hard: character consistency across scenes, specific camera angles, maintaining visual continuity.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: pre-visualization, storyboarding, client pitch visuals, B-roll. Leaves if: no consistency controls, no team features, or competitors offer better video quality.

5. Pain Points

- Character/scene consistency across multiple generations is critical and lacking
- No storyboard view/workflow
- Can't specify camera angles reliably
- No team/collaboration features
- Long video timeline is manual and tedious

6. Delight Moments

- Auto-mode: script → storyboard → video (even rough) would be game-changing
- First/last frame control for scene continuity
- Client sharing a storyboard deck generated in 30 minutes vs. 2 days

7. Willingness to Pay $50-100/month for team. Justifies as production cost savings. Would pay significantly more for broadcast-quality output and team features.

SEGMENT 6: Kids / Students (2)

Persona 14: Tommy, 11 — "School Project Kid"

Bio: 6th grader. Needs visuals for school presentations and projects. Uses Google Slides. Parents monitor his screen time and app usage.

1. First Encounter Classmate shows him at school: "Look what I made for my history project!" First impression: *"This is SO COOL, I want to make a dinosaur fighting a robot."*

2. Onboarding Expects: type something, get something cool. Zero patience. Needs kid-friendly interface. Parents need: content safety, no inappropriate outputs, clear privacy policy.

3. First Creation Tries: "Roman gladiator in a colosseum for my history project." Easy: the magic of seeing his idea become an image. Hard: nothing, if the core loop is simple. Frustrated if: content filter blocks "gladiator" or "fighting."

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: every school project, making cool art to show friends, exploring creativity. Leaves if: free credits run out and parents won't pay.

5. Pain Points

- Overly aggressive content moderation blocking legitimate school topics
- Parents worried about AI-generated content for schoolwork (academic integrity)
- Free tier too limited for regular use
- Can't easily use images in Google Slides

6. Delight Moments

- First "whoa" moment showing friends and teachers
- Making a video for a school presentation that wows the class
- Community where kids share school project art

7. Willingness to Pay Parents might pay $3-5/month for an "education" tier. School/district licensing could be an avenue. Ad-supported free tier for kids is ethically tricky.

Persona 15: Zara, 19 — "Art School Student"

Bio: First-year university art student. Uses Procreate, some Photoshop. Interested in AI as a creative tool but conflicted about AI art ethics. Exploring what's possible.

1. First Encounter Professor assigns "create a piece using AI tools and critically analyze the process." Tries Craftit. First impression: *"Let me see what this can do, and what it can't."*

2. Onboarding Expects: creative control. Wants to understand how it works, not just get output. Interested in the process, not just results.

3. First Creation Tries: surrealist self-portrait concept — uploads reference sketch, wants AI to develop it further. Easy: generating from text. Hard: using her own sketches as starting points, maintaining her artistic intent, feeling like she's still the creator.

4. Repeat Usage Returns for: ideation, exploring styles, generating reference material, school assignments. Leaves if: feels like the tool does ALL the creative work (wants to stay the artist), or if ethical concerns increase.

5. Pain Points

- No sketch-to-image workflow (wants to start from her drawings)
- Ethical concerns about AI training data and artist attribution
- No way to control HOW MUCH the AI changes vs. preserves
- Watermark/attribution unclear — is it "her" work?

6. Delight Moments

- Using reference image feature with her sketch as the starting point
- AI as collaborator, not replacement — keeping her style while expanding possibilities
- Making a video art piece for class that blends AI and traditional art

7. Willingness to Pay Would pay $5-8/month with student discount. Values ethical transparency. Would pay more if the company is transparent about training data and supports artists.

Cross-Segment Synthesis

Top 10 Cross-Segment Insights

1. **The 30-Second Rule** — Every segment expects to see a creation within 30-60 seconds of opening the app. Any friction before the first "wow" moment is fatal, especially for beginners, teens, and kids.

2. **Text on Images is a Universal Need** — From Linda's birthday invitations to Jake's YouTube thumbnails, nearly every persona needs to add text to AI-generated images. Pure image generation without text/design tools is a half-product. The Canvas feature is not a nice-to-have — it's essential.

3. **Consistency is the #1 Professional Barrier** — Segments 3-5 all cite style/character/brand consistency as a top pain point. Without it, Craftit remains a toy for occasional use rather than a workflow tool.

4. **Reference Image is the Killer Feature** — Across all segments, the ability to use their own images (products, food, sketches, photos) as starting points is what separates Craftit from "another AI art generator." This bridges "cool AI images" and "useful for MY life."

5. **"Is This My Work?" Identity Question** — From Zara (ethics) to Jake (brand) to Linda (pride), users across all segments want to feel ownership over creations. The tool must feel like it amplifies THEM, not replaces them.

6. **Price Sensitivity Spans 10x** — Willingness to pay ranges from $0 (Aisha/Tommy) to $100/month (Nina's team). A single pricing tier won't work. Need: free → casual ($5-10) → pro ($20-30) → team ($50+).

7. **Templates/Workflows > Blank Canvas** — Beginners and business owners don't want creative freedom — they want guided workflows. "What do you want to make?" → category → template → customize. Only professionals want the blank canvas.

8. **Video is the Differentiator, Images are the Entry** — Users discover Craftit for images but stay for video. Short video generation is what competitors (Canva, basic AI tools) can't easily match. Auto-mode long video is the moonshot feature.

9. **Community is Double-Edged** — Aisha and Tommy love it (social validation). Priya fears it (exposing her "secret tool"). Professionals ignore it. Community should be opt-in and never feel like a requirement.

10. **Speed = Respect for User's Time** — Every persona, without exception, mentions speed. For a teen, it's impatience. For a business owner, it's "I don't have time." For a creator, it's "I need volume." Fast generation isn't a technical flex — it's a core value proposition.

Segment-Specific Needs Matrix

Need	Beginners	Casual	Creators	SMB	Professional	Kids/Students
Templates/guided flows	★★★	★★	★	★★★	☆	★★
Text on images	★★★	★★★	★★★	★★★	★★	★
Brand consistency	☆	★★	★★★	★★	★★★	☆
Reference image	★	★★	★★	★★★	★★★	★
Batch/bulk creation	☆	★	★★★	★★	★★	☆

Need	Beginners	Casual	Creators	SMB	Professional	Kids/Students
Video generation	★	★★	★★★	★★	★★★	★★
Multi-format export	☆	★★	★★★	★★	★★★	☆
Simple/fast UX	★★★	★★	★★	★★★	★	★★★
Advanced controls	☆	★	★★	☆	★★★	☆
Community/social	★	★★	★	☆	☆	★★★
Auto-mode video	★	★	★★★	★★	★★★	★
Content safety	★★	★	★	★	★	★★★

★★★ = Critical | ★★ = Important | ★ = Nice to have | ☆ = Low priority

---

Critical UX Moments (Make-or-Break)

1. **First Generation Result (ALL segments)** — If the first image/video isn't impressive, users leave immediately. This moment carries the entire product. Optimize default quality, pre-fill good prompts, show best-case examples.

2. **"How Do I Edit This?" (Beginners, SMB)** — The moment after generation when a user wants to change ONE thing. If there's no edit path, they feel stuck. Canvas feature directly addresses this.

3. **"It Doesn't Look Like MY Brand/Product" (Creators, SMB, Professional)** — The moment a professional user realizes AI output is generic, not theirs. Reference images + style saving + brand kits are the answer.

4. **Sign-Up Wall Timing** — Requiring sign-up BEFORE first generation is a conversion killer for Beginners and Kids. Let them generate one image free, then gate.

5. **Credit Exhaustion Moment** — When free credits run out. This is where pricing, value communication, and upgrade UX either convert or lose the user forever.

6. **Share Flow** — The moment a user wants to share their creation. Every extra tap between "done" and "shared on Instagram/WhatsApp" is friction. One-tap share is essential.

7. **Second Session Return** — Day 2-3 after first use. Does the user have a reason to come back? Saved projects, templates, and "try this next" suggestions drive return visits.

Feature Priority (User Perspective)

Tier 1: Must-Have (blocks adoption without these)

1. Canvas / text overlay on AI images
2. Reference image generation (use my photos as input)
3. Simple guided creation flows (templates by use case)
4. Fast generation (< 30 seconds for images)
5. Easy sharing (one-tap to social/messaging)

Tier 2: Growth Drivers (converts trial → paid)

6. Style saving & consistency across sessions

7. Brand kit (colors, fonts, logo)
8. Multi-format export (social media sizes)
9. Video generation quality improvements
10. Auto-mode long video (idea → final video)

Tier 3: Retention & Expansion

11. Batch/bulk generation
12. Team collaboration
13. API access
14. Advanced controls (composition, camera, parameters)
15. Scheduling / publishing integration

The "Magic Moment" — Per Segment

Segment	Magic Moment
Complete Beginners	"I described what I wanted and got something that looks PROFESSIONAL. I made this!" — The first time their AI creation looks better than anything they could have made with any other tool.
Casual Creators	"I just made in 5 minutes what used to take me 2 hours in Canva." — Speed + quality that clearly surpasses their current workflow.
Content Creators	"I generated a full week of content in one sitting." — Volume + consistency that transforms their production capacity.
Small Business	"A customer said my ad looked like it was made by a professional agency." — External validation that AI-generated content drives real business results.
Professional	"I showed 10 concept directions to my client in the first meeting — they were blown away." — AI as a professional superpower that elevates their work, not a threat.
Kids/Students	"Everyone in class wanted to know how I made my presentation look so cool." — Social currency and creative empowerment.

Strategic Recommendations

1. **Lead with Canvas, not just generation.** Pure AI image generation is commoditizing. The canvas workflow (generate → design → finish) is the defensible product.

2. **Build "use case" entry points, not feature entry points.** Don't show "Image Generation" and "Video Generation." Show "Birthday Invitation," "Product Photo," "YouTube Thumbnail," "Social Post." Let the AI figure out what tools to use.

3. **Reference image is the wedge for business users.** It's what makes the tool USEFUL (not just cool). Prioritize accuracy of reference-based generation.

4. **Auto-mode long video is the moonshot.** No one else does idea → script → storyboard → video well. This could define the category.

5. **Offer a free "Education" tier.** Kids and students are future power users. Seed the market. Partner with schools.

6. **Style consistency is the technical moat.** The team that cracks reliable style/character/brand consistency across generations wins the creator and business market.

End of synthetic research report.